Deploying Cloud Native Qumulo (CNQ) on AWS with Terraform release v7.9

This repository contains Terraform which deploys S3 buckets and a CNQ cluster with 3 or more instances that adhere to the AWS Well-Architected Framework. NOTE: as of version 7.0 this Terraform uses the Qumulo AWS Provider. This greatly simplifies Terraform operations and makes compute elasticity changes even more elegant. To learn more about the provider read the provider docs.

Configure Terraform backend.tf

This Terraform defaults to store state on S3. As such the ./backend.tf must both be configured with the S3 bucket and S3 bucket region you choose to store state in. Note you can't put variables in the backend.tf config, which is why this note is here. If you call this Terraform as a module the backend.tf will be ignored.

Getting Started with Cloud Native Qumulo (CNQ)

For an overview of CNQ, its reference architecture, and limits, see How Cloud Native Qumulo Works and for prerequisites and detailed instructions, see Deploying Cloud Native Qumulo on AWS with Terraform on the Documentation Portal.

Qumulo Core >= 7.9.2.1 is required for this Terraform

> ✅ **Tip:** For help with deployment, configuration, updates, scaling out your cluster, and best practices for high performance, message us on Slack.

Standard Deployment Example

```
module "cloud_native_qumulo" {
  source = "git::https://github.com/Qumulo/qumulo-terraform-aws.git?ref=v8.0"
  # ***************************** QUMULO PROVIDER VARIABLES ********************
  #-----------REQUIRED-------------------
  deployment_name = "my-deployment-name"
  ec2_key_pair    = "my-key-pair"
  instance_type   = "i7i.2xlarge"
  region          = "us-west-2"
  subnet_ids      = ["subnet-0123456789abcdef1"]
  vpc_id          = "vpc-0123456789abcdef1"

  #-----------OPTIONAL-----------------
  additional_security_group_ids = null
  allow_cidrs                   = null
  ami_id                        = null
  ami_parameter_name            = null
  cluster_iam_role_arn          = null
  cluster_security_group_id     = null
  kms_key_id                    = null
  permissions_boundary_arn      = null
  provisioner_iam_role_arn      = null
  provisioner_instance_type     = null
  provisioner_security_group_id = null
  s3_gateway_validation         = null
  s3_log_bucket_name            = null
  s3_log_bucket_prefix          = null
  tags = {
    owner        = "owner"
    department   = "department"
    purpose      = "purpose"
    long_running = "true"
  }

  # ***** Qumulo Cluster Variables ******
  #-----------REQUIRED-------------------
  admin_pwd_or_secrets_arn = "arn:aws:secretsmanager:us-west-2:<aws account number>:secret:/<secret
path>/<secret_name>"
```

```
  cluster_name             = "CNQ-HOT"
  cluster_product_type     = "HOT"
  deletion_protection      = true
  nexus_api_token_or_secrets_arn = "arn:aws:secretsmanager:us-west-2:<aws account
number>:secret:/<secret path>/<secret_name>"
  node_count               = 3

  #------------OPTIONAL------------------
  audit_logging                  = false
  cluster_stall_window_minutes   = 20
  cluster_version                = null
  floating_ip_count              = 12
  ip_v4_or_v6                    = "v4"
  node_replacement_when_changed  = null
  provider_timeout_minutes       = 30
  soft_capacity_limit_tb         = null
  storage_class                  = null
}

output "outputs_cloud_native_qumulo" {
  value = module.cloud_native_qumulo
}
```

NeuralSearch (optional)

NeuralSearch is a Qumulo appliance that indexes the files on your cluster and serves a search UI. This module deploys it as a single EC2 VM in the cluster VPC and first subnet. It is off by default. The module uses the `qumulo_neuralsearch_aws` provider resource, which requires Qumulo provider 1.4.25 or later.

Enable NeuralSearch

Set these variables in `terraform.tfvars` or in your module block.

```
ns_provision     = true
ns_allow_cidrs   = null # CIDR blocks allowed to reach the UI on TCP 443. Null allows the cluster VPC
CIDR.
ns_instance_type = null # Null uses the provider default (m6a.4xlarge).
```

Deletion protection follows `deletion_protection` for the Qumulo Cluster.

Networking requirements

- The appliance subnet needs outbound HTTPS (for example through a NAT gateway) to `qumulo-neuralsearch.s3.us-west-2.amazonaws.com`, `get.docker.com`, `download.docker.com`, `public.ecr.aws`, the Ubuntu package mirrors, and `ssm.<region>.amazonaws.com` (or an SSM interface endpoint). If any are blocked, the apply waits until `provider_timeout_minutes` expires.
- The appliance must reach the cluster on TCP 8000 and NFS. The default `allow_cidrs` covers this because the VPC CIDR is always included. If you bring your own cluster security group with `cluster_security_group_id`, add these rules yourself.
- The UI listens on TCP 443 at the appliance private IP. Add peered VPC, VPN, or Direct Connect ranges to `neuralsearch_allow_cidrs` to reach it from outside the VPC.

First-boot wizard

1. Open the `neuralsearch_ui_url` output in a browser. Expect a self-signed certificate warning.
2. For SAZ clusters enter either a floating IP or the DNS name. For MAZ clusters enter the NLB DNS name.
3. Sign in with a cluster account that holds the Administrators or Observers role.

Access the appliance

The appliance has no public IP. Open a shell through AWS Systems Manager with the `neuralsearch_instance_id` output.

```
aws ssm start-session --target <neuralsearch_instance_id> --region <region>
```

Cost

The appliance uses a 1 TiB gp3 OS disk provisioned at 80,000 IOPS and 2,000 MiB/s. IOPS and throughput above the gp3 baseline are billed. The default instance type is m6a.4xlarge.

Limitations

The `qumulo_neuralsearch_aws` resource does not support `terraform import`.

NeuralProtect (Optional)

Deploys a Qumulo NeuralProtect appliance alongside an existing Qumulo cluster on AWS.

Bootstrap and network prerequisites

First-boot bootstrap always runs `apt-get update` and `dist-upgrade` from the cloud provider's Ubuntu archive mirrors. Bootstrap tools (`curl`, `gnupg`, and cloud-specific extras) and Docker (>= 20.10, `docker-ce` or `docker.io`) are installed only when missing; pre-baked images that already include them skip those apt steps. When Docker is not already on the VM image, bootstrap tries `docker.io` from those mirrors first and falls back to Docker CE from the **Nexus artifacts proxy** (`<nexus-api>/artifacts/docker/`) when public apt is blocked.

The Elastio `.deb` is fetched from the **Nexus artifacts proxy** for your Qumulo Nexus environment (for example `https://api.nexus.qumulo.com/artifacts/elastio/...`). The provider resolves `package_url` from that proxy when omitted. Explicit `package_url` values must be served from that proxy path unless `bootstrap_allow_public_internet` is set; public URLs (for example direct object-store links) are rejected at plan time when locked down.

The Threat Detection VM needs outbound HTTPS to your Qumulo Nexus API (artifacts proxy, fleet-service license channel, and appliance registration) and to your cloud provider APIs.

Custom or hardened images must include `curl`, `gnupg`, and `python3` (installed from apt by default). Bootstrap reads the cluster bearer from the dedicated TD Secrets Manager secret via the instance profile (IMDSv2 credentials + `curl --aws-sigv4` and `python3`, installed from the cloud provider's Ubuntu archive during bootstrap). Missing Elastio package dependencies may be satisfied from the image's Ubuntu apt sources during `dpkg` install.

Example Usage

```
np_deletion_protection = true
np_instance_type       = "m6a.4xlarge"
np_provision           = true
```

Accessing the NeuralProtect Dashboard

The NeuralProtect dashboard and configuration options are accessed via Qumulo Nexus. Select your cluster and then choose the Threat Detection Tab.

Accessing the NeuralProtect VM

The TD VM has no public IP and no inbound rules from the Internet. Operators reach it via AWS Systems Manager Session Manager — the AWS parallel to Azure AD SSH. The instance role grants the `AmazonSSMManagedInstanceCore` managed policy so the SSM agent can register on first boot. No SSH key is required.

Connect with:

```
aws ssm start-session --target <instance-id> --region <region>
```

Deletion Protection

Set `np_deletion_protection = true` to protect the appliance EC2 instance with termination protection (`DisableApiTermination`). Deleting a protected appliance is a deliberate two-step: set `np_deletion_protection = false`, run `terraform apply`, then run `terraform destroy`. Running destroy without the intermediate apply is refused, because the gate reads the prior state.

Replacement interaction: most of this resource's attributes (for example `os_disk_size_gb`) force replacement, and a replacement starts with a delete — so any replace-triggering change on a protected appliance is refused by the same gate. It takes **two separate applies**: first apply `deletion_protection = false` alone, then apply the replacing change. Combining both in one apply still fails because the replacement's delete reads the prior (protected) state. `create_before_destroy` does not avoid this: appliance resource names are deterministic from the cluster UUID, so a replacement instance cannot coexist with the protected one. This is intentional — a protected appliance cannot be silently recreated.

Terraform Documentation

ℹ️ **Note:** This repository uses documentation generated with Terraform-Docs.

Requirements

Name	Version
terraform	>= 1.11.0
aws	>= 5.32
null	>= 3.1
qumulo	>= 1.4.27
random	>= 3.1

Inputs

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
additional_security_group_ids	OPTIONAL: Use for adding custom ingress rules beyond those the provider creates	`list(string)`	`null`	no
admin_pwd_or_secrets_arn	Provide either a plaintext administrator password or an AWS Secrets Manager ARN.	`string`	n/a	yes
allow_cidrs	OPTIONAL: CIDR blocks allowed to access the cluster	`list(string)`	`null`	no
ami_id	OPTIONAL: AMI ID for cluster nodes. If omitted, the default Qumulo AMI (Ubuntu 24.04) is used. Supports Ubuntu and RHEL 8, 9, and 10 AMIs. See aws-custom-images.md for details.	`string`	`null`	no
ami_parameter_name	OPTIONAL: AWS Systems Manager Parameter Store parameter name to lookup the AMI. Takes priority over ami_id if provided.	`string`	`null`	no
audit_logging	OPTIONAL: Send Qumulo audit logs to AWS CloudWatch logs.	`bool`	`false`	no
cluster_dns_name	OPTIONAL: DNS Name for the cluster. Leave null to automatically pickup the QDNS or NLB DNS name.	`string`	`null`	no
cluster_fqdn	OPTIONAL: Fully qualified domain name for Qumulo DNS	`string`	`null`	no

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
cluster_iam_role_arn	OPTIONAL: When set, the provider performs no IAM writes for that role — no creation, policy updates, tagging, or deletion — and instead launches instances with your role's instance profile	`string`	`null`	no
cluster_name	Cluster name (2-15 alphanumeric characters). Used as a prefix for AWS resources created for this cluster.	`string`	n/a	yes
cluster_product_type	Cluster storage product type (immutable after creation). HOT: Optimized for frequently accessed data. COLD: Optimized for archival/infrequently accessed data.	`string`	n/a	yes
cluster_security_group_id	OPTIONAL: Bring-your-own security group ID for cluster nodes. When set, the provider will not create or modify a cluster security group; you must pre-create it in the VPC owner account with the rules documented in the Bring-your-own Security Groups guide. Required together with provisioner_security_group_id. Required for RAM-shared subnets where the consumer account cannot create security groups in the owner's VPC.	`string`	`null`	no
cluster_stall_window_minutes	OPTIONAL: The time after which Terraform will abondon the provider deployment if the Qumulo cluster is not progressing with the deployment. In minutes.	`number`	`20`	no
cluster_version	OPTIONAL: Qumulo software version. Defaults to latest. Immutable after creation. Upgrade version via cluster UI/API.	`string`	`null`	no
deletion_protection	Enables EC2 Termination protection and prevents Terraform from destroying non-empty S3 Buckets	`bool`	`true`	no

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
deployment_name	Cluster name (2-15 alphanumeric characters). Used as a prefix for AWS resources created for this cluster.	`string`	n/a	yes
ec2_key_pair	EC2 key pair name for SSH access to cluster nodes	`string`	n/a	yes
floating_ip_count	OPTIONAL: Number of floating IPs. Must be 0, or between 3 and 100. NOT applicable with multi-AZ deployments.	`number`	`12`	no
instance_type	EC2 instance type for the cluster. Prefer i7i, i4i, i7ien. Supported families include m6idn, m6i, m7i, i3en, i4i, i7i, i7ie.	`string`	n/a	yes
ip_v4_or_v6	OPTIONAL: Only change this from default (v4) if connecting to the cluster via IPv6. Not supported for clusters deployed without the Qumulo Terraform Provider.	`string`	`"v4"`	no
kms_key_id	OPTIONAL: KMS key ARN for encrypting AWS services like EBS and S3 (immutable after creation). Qumulo encrypts all data independent of AWS default or KMS keys.	`string`	`null`	no
networking_mode	OPTIONAL: Only change this from default (host_managed) if importing a cluster that was deployed without the Qumulo Terraform Provider. Terraform versions prior to 7.0.	`string`	`"host_managed"`	no
nexus_api_token_or_secrets_arn	Provide either a plaintext Nexus API token or an AWS Secrets Manager ARN for the token.	`string`	n/a	yes
nlb_cross_zone	OPTIONAL: AWS NLB Enable cross-AZ load balancing	`bool`	`false`	no
nlb_deletion_protection	Enables NLB Termination protection and prevents Terraform from destroying the NLB	`bool`	`true`	no
nlb_dns_client_affinity	OPTIONAL: AWS NLB DNS Client Routing Policy Zonal Affinity	`string`	`"availability_zone_affinity"`	no
nlb_override_subnet_ids	OPTIONAL: Private Subnet ID(s) for NLB if deploying in subnet(s) other than subnet(s) the cluster is deployed in	`list(string)`	`null`	no

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
nlb_provision	OPTIONAL: Provision an AWS NLB in front of the Qumulo cluster for load balancing and client failover	`bool`	`false`	no
nlb_public	OPTIONAL: Makes the NLB for the cluster public, setting this to true will allow anyone to reach the cluster. Not recommended for production clusters.	`bool`	`false`	no
nlb_stickiness	OPTIONAL: AWS NLB sticky sessions	`bool`	`true`	no
node_count	Number of nodes in the cluster. Valid values: 1 (single node), or 3-24. 1 and 4 not allowed for multi-AZ.	`number`	n/a	yes
node_hooks_files	OPTIONAL: Pre and post userdata hooks files for Cluster Nodes.	`map(string)`	`null`	no
node_replacement_when_changed	OPTIONAL: Changing the random string will trigger a node replacement with the same EC2 instance type. A typical use case would be to put in yyyy-mm-dd that you trigger a replace.	`string`	`null`	no
np_deletion_protection	OPTIONAL: Causes Terraform to throw an error upon destroy for the NeuralProtect resource. Safegaurd your NeuralProtect instance. Set to false to destroy.	`bool`	`true`	no
np_instance_type	OPTIONAL: NeuralProtect EC2 instance type.	`string`	`null`	no
np_provision	OPTIOINAL: true/false to enable deployment of NeuralProtect.	`bool`	`false`	no
ns_allow_cidrs	OPTIONAL: CIDR blocks allowed to reach the NeuralSearch UI on TCP 443. Defaults to the cluster VPC CIDR. Add peered VPC, VPN, or Direct Connect ranges here.	`list(string)`	`null`	no
ns_instance_type	OPTIONAL: NeuralSearch EC2 instance type. Null uses the provider default (m6a.4xlarge).	`string`	`null`	no
ns_provision	OPTIONAL: true/false to enable deployment of the NeuralSearch appliance.	`bool`	`false`	no
permissions_boundary_arn	OPTIONAL: IAM permissions boundary ARN applied to	`string`	`null`	no

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
	cluster and provisioner roles			
provider_timeout_minutes	The total time after which Terraform will abondon the provider deployment of the Qumulo cluster and timeout. In minutes.	`number`	`30`	no
provisioner_hooks_files	OPTIONAL: Pre and post userdata hooks files for the provisioner.	`map(string)`	`null`	no
provisioner_iam_role_arn	OPTIONAL: When set, the provider performs no IAM writes for that role — no creation, policy updates, tagging, or deletion — and instead launches instances with your role's instance profile	`string`	`null`	no
provisioner_instance_type	OPTIONAL: EC2 instance type for the provisioner VM (used during deploy operations). Default: m5.xlarge.	`string`	`"m5.xlarge"`	no
provisioner_security_group_id	OPTIONAL: Bring-your-own security group ID for the provisioner instance. Required together with cluster_security_group_id. See cluster_security_group_id.	`string`	`null`	no
r53_second_subnet_id	OPTIONAL: A second subnet ID, in a unique AZ other than the cluster AZ, for single AZ clusters. This is then used to build a R53 Resolver to forward traffic to Qumulo DNS for Floating IP resolution.	`string`	`null`	no
region	AWS region for deployment	`string`	n/a	yes
s3_gateway_validation	OPTIONAL: Terraform will test for an S3 gateway if this is left at null or set to true. Set to false for environments that have complex VPC networking.	`bool`	`null`	no
s3_log_bucket_name	OPTIONAL: Bucket name for S3 logging	`string`	`null`	no
s3_log_bucket_prefix	OPTIONAL: Bucket prefix for S3 logging	`string`	`null`	no
soft_capacity_limit_tb	OPTIONAL: Soft capacity limit in TB (50 to 50000). Default is 2000TB per instance at first quorum formation. Can be increased to add storage, but cannot be decreased. It's like a quota, unused capacity is not billed.	`number`	`null`	no

Name	Description	Type	Default	Required
storage_class	HOT cluster default is INTELLIGENT_TIERING or STANDARD, COLD cluster default is GLACIER_IR or STANDARD_IA	`string`	`null`	no
subnet_ids	Subnet ID for a single AZ deployment or 3+ subnets, one per AZ, for a multi-AZ deployment)	`list(string)`	n/a	yes
tags	OPTIONAL: Tags to apply to all AWS resources created for this cluster.	`map(string)`	`null`	no
vpc_id	VPC ID for the cluster	`string`	n/a	yes

Outputs

Name	Description
cluster_name	Name of the Qumulo cluster
cluster_soft_capacity_limit_tb	Total capacity the cluster may consume. Only used capacity is billed.
cluster_uuid	UUID of the Qumulo cluster
deployment_unique_name	Unique deployment identifier
endpoint_ips	Client-facing IPs. Floating IPs if configured, otherwise primary IPs.
endpoints	Connection endpoints for various protocols
neuralprotect_private_ip	IP address for the NeuralProtect appliance.
neuralsearch_private_ip	Private IP address of the NeuralSearch appliance. Null when NeuralSearch is not provisioned.
neuralsearch_ui_url	URL of the NeuralSearch web UI. Null when NeuralSearch is not provisioned.
primary_ips	Per-node primary IPs. Use these directly when no floating IPs are configured, or for per-node access.
provisioner_log	CloudWatch Log for the provisioner

About This Repository

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